Robert Reimer

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Education

Ph.D.	Since 2024	Philosophy	Transferred to UIUC. Supervised by Prof. John Schwenkler.
Visiting Researcher	2019	Philosophy	UC Berkeley. Invited by Prof. Alva Noë.
Visiting Researcher	2018	Philosophy	UChicago. Invited by Prof. James Conant.
Ph.D.	2017-2023	Philosophy	University of Leipzig. Supervised by Prof. James Conant.
M.A.	2015-2017	Philosophy	University of Leipzig. Supervised by Prof. Pirmin Stekeler-Weithofer. Grade: 1.1.
B.A.	2012-2015	Philosophy	University of Leipzig. Supervised by Prof. Pirmin Stekeler-Weithofer. Grade: 1.2.
B.A.	2010-2015	Literary Writing	University of Leipzig. Supervised by Prof. Hans-Ulrich Treichel. Grade: 1.7.

Research Interests

AOS:	Philosophy of Action, Philosophy of Mind, Continental Philosophy (with a focus on Phenomenology).
AOC:	Ethics, Philosophy of Language, Metaphysics.

Dissertation

Title: *The Body in Action*.

Committee: John Schwenkler (Chair),
Jochen Bojanowski, John Hummel, Matthias Haase, Kristina Musholt.

In the spirit of the phenomenological tradition, many philosophers of mind have explored how the human body shapes the mind under the title 'philosophy of embodiment' in the last 50 years. Within that field, it is largely agreed upon that the human body is not only the realization base of our thoughts and perceptions; its particular shape and motion also determine the very form of how we think about the world and how we perceive it. However, these insights have had little impact on the philosophy of action. Here, the role of the body has still been either ignored or misunderstood. This is strange given that it is the body that moves (or rather, that we move) when we act – its organs (our hands and feet) are our primary organs of agency. The purpose of my dissertation is to fill this gap. First, I criticize various misconceptions of what the (moving) body is and what bodily movements (as the core elements of our actions) are. Then I explore how the shape, enculturation, and abilities of our body determine the very form of our practical reasoning and our agential space.

Teaching

Undergraduate	Spring 2026	Intro to Philosophy	UIUC. As independent instructor.
Undergraduate	Fall 2025	Intro to Ethics	UIUC. As independent instructor.
Undergraduate	Fall 2024	Logic and Reasoning	UIUC. As teaching assistant.
Undergraduate	Spring 2024	Intro to Ethics	UIUC. As teaching assistant.
Upper-level undergraduate	Winter 2019	Davidson: Essays on Actions and Events	University of Leipzig. As independent instructor.
Lower-level undergraduate	Winter 2018	On the Pursuit of Truth	University of Leipzig. As independent instructor.
Upper-level undergraduate	Summer 2017	Strawson in the Context of …	University of Leipzig. As independent instructor.

Philosophical Publications

In (peer-reviewed) journals

2025 Reimer, R.: "Explanatory reasons, actions, and the right fit", *Synthese* 206 (272).

2024 Reimer, R.: "Play as an autotelic activity. A defense", *Sport, Ethics and Philosophy*, 19 (3).

2023 Reimer, R.: "The Vienna Circle and its critical reception of Oswald Spengler", *Philosophical Journal of Conflict and Violence* 7 (1).

2021 Reimer, R.: "Perceiving causality in action", *Synthese* 199.

2019 Reimer, R.: "Benjamin Libet und der freie Wille", *Arbeitstitel* 7(1).

In edited volumes

2023 Borchers, R. & Reimer, R.: "Staat als Moralproblem – Das Politische in Moritz Schlicks Kulturphilosophie", in: *Der Wiener Kreis und sein philosophisches Spektrum*. Metzler.

2022 Reimer, R.: "What does it mean to inhibit an action? A critical discussion of Benjamin Libet's veto in a recent study", in: *LNCS*, vol. 13230, Springer, Cham.

2021 Reimer, R.: "Against the Illusory Will Hypothesis. A reinterpretation of the test results from Daniel Wegner and Thalia Wheatley's *I Spy*-experiment", in: *LNCS*, vol. 12524. Springer, Cham.

Philosophical translations (English to German)

Forth. Conant, J.; Haag, J.; Barth, C.; Reimer, R. (eds.): *Der Logische Fremde* [*The Logical Alien*]. Basel, Berlin: Schwabe Verlag. (approx. 1,200 pages)

2021 Conant, J.: "Einige Sokratische Merkmale in Wittgensteins Philosophie", ["Some Socratic aspects in Wittgenstein's philosophy,"] in: *Orientierung durch Kritik. Essays zum philosophischen Werk Pirmin Stekeler-Weithofers*. Meiner: Hamburg, 283-324.

Reviews

2023 Reimer, R.: "Karl Kraatz: Das Sein zur Sprache bringen. Die Formale Anzeige als Kern der Begriffs- und Bedeutungstheorie Martin Heideggers", *Phenomenological Reviews*.

Works in Progress

Under Review:	"On the Puzzle of Intention in Hegel's *Philosophy of Right*."
In Progress:	"Grasping, Using, Dominating. A Heideggerian Account of the Human Hand."
	"Bodily Action and Ergative Verbs."
	"The Tool of all Tools."
Early Stage:	"Embodiment and Practical Reasoning."

Public Presentations

11/2026 "On Action Verbs and Their Causal Analysis." *19th Annual Michael Gelven NIU Graduate Philosophy Conference*. DeKalb.

10/2026 "Grasping, Using, Dominating? A Heideggerian Critique of Common Assumptions about the Human Hand." *Annual Conference of the Illinois Philosophical Association* (IPA). Illinois State University, Normal.

07/2026 "On the Logical Form of Obligations to Oneself." *Workshop on Obligations to Oneself*. University of Göttingen. (Invited speaker)

07/2025 "Ergative verbs and bodily action. Rebutting the linguistic argument for agent-causalism." *7th Göttingen / Chicago Graduate Conference*. University of Göttingen.

06/2025 "Play as an autotelic activity." *SoPhA 2025 – Action*. University of Nantes.

01/2025 "Explanatory reasons, actions, and the right fit." *AIL5*. Virtual.

10/2024 "Epistemic actions and extended cognition." *2nd Annual Web Conference of the ISPSM*. Virtual.

07/2024 "On the right place of causation in action." *6th Göttingen / Chicago Graduate Conference*. University of Göttingen.

01/2024 "Actions, bodily movements, and events in the world." *AIL4*. Virtual.

10/2023 "Causally complex actions and extended cognition." *Warwick-Geneva-Leipzig Interdepartmental Worksho*p. University of Geneva. (Invited speaker)

07/2023 "Causally complex actions and extended cognition." *5th Göttingen / Chicago Graduate Conference*. University of Göttingen.

02/2023 "On causally complex action. What does it mean to cause a change by acting?" *ECOM's 4th Graduate Conference – Kinds of Action*. Virtual.

10/2022 "Fakt und Fake." *Leipzig Denkt* (*Philosophy Festival*). University of Leipzig.

01/2022 "Peter Strawson und der Angriff auf die Korrespondenztheorie der Wahrheit." *Leipziger Promotionsvorträge*. University of Leipzig.

12/2021 "What does it mean to inhibit an action?" *3rd International Workshop on CIFMA*. Virtual.

08/2021 "On the search of Cartesian ideas in interruption and cancellation studies." *28th Conference of the European Society for Philosophy and Psychology (ESPP*). Virtual.

09/2020 "Against the Illusory Will Hypothesis." *2nd International Workshop on CIFMA*. Virtual.

12/2019 "The influence of the spectator on the internal teleology of sport games." *HSSA Workshop - The Role of the Spectator*. UC Berkeley.

12/2019 "An analysis of identity based on Frege's knowledge-requirement for identity statements." *Phil Forum*. UC Berkeley.

10/2019 "What's puzzling Gottlob Frege?" *HSSA Workshop – Approaches to Identity*. UC Berkeley.

09/2019 "Descartes, Libet and the free will." *HSSA Colloquium*. UC Berkeley. (Invited speaker)

06/2019 "Identity." *HSSA Spring Symposium*. UC Berkeley.

06/2019 "Wie wirkt der freie Wille?" *Philosophische Sommergespräche*. University of Erfurt.

01/2019 "Benjamin Libet und der freie Wille." *Leipziger Promotionsvorträge*. University of Leipzig.

07/2018 "Hegel on intention." *Philosophy of Right – Kant, Fichte, Hegel*. University of Leipzig.

Conference Organization

03/2026 (with Ana López) *UIUC Grad Conference*. Keynote Speakers: Anton Ford, John Schwenkler.

12/2019 (with Viktoria Huegel) *HSSA Workshop – The Role of the Spectator*. UC Berkeley.

10/2019 *HSSA Workshop – Approaches to Identity*. UC Berkeley.

Expert Reports and Supervision

Journals: *Ergo*; *Synthese*; *Sport, Ethics and Philosophy*; *Philosophical Psychology*; *Arbeitstitel*; *Qeios*.

Theses: One M.A. thesis at University of Leipzig.

Scholarships and Awards

2026-27 Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UIUC

2026 Distinguished Graduate Teaching Award, UIUC

2019 Travel and Research Scholarship, *DAAD*.

2018-21 Full Scholarship for graduate students, *the state of Saxony.*

2018 Travel and Research Scholarship, *FAGI*.

2017 Full Scholarship for undergraduate students, *Studienstiftung des Deutschen Volkes*.

Memberships and Service

Since 2026 Society for Phenomenology and Existential Philosophy (SPEP)

Since 2025 International Association for the Philosophy of Sport (IAPS)

Since 2022 Action Network (chairing and general service)

Graduate Coursework

At the University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign

Fall 2025 On the *Cognitive Sciences* with Prof. John Hummel.

Spring 2025 On the *Philosophy of AI* with Prof. Kevin Scharp.

Spring 2025 On *Voluntariness* with Prof. John Schwenkler.

Fall 2024 On *Race, Sex, and Gender* with Prof. Alison Kerr and Prof. Jordan Pascoe.

Fall 2024 On the *Philosophy of Mind* with Prof. John Schwenkler.

Spring 2024	On *Metaphysics* with Prof. Christopher Weaver.
Spring 2024	On the *Philosophy of Logic* with Prof. Jonathan Livengood.

At the University of Leipzig

Summer 2017	On the *Philosophy of Embodiment* with Prof. Kristina Musholt.
Winter 2016	On *Hegel's Philosophy of Right* with Prof. Matthias Haase and Dr. Wolfram Gobsch.
Winter 2016	On *Dispositions* with Prof. Kristina Engelhard.
Winter 2016	On *Self-Objectivization* with Prof. Thomas Khurana.
Summer 2016	On the *Philosophy of Games* with Dr. Geert Lueke-Lueken.
Summer 2016	On *Thought Experiments* with Dr. Geert Lueke-Lueken.
Summer 2016	On the *Theories of Rationality* with Dr. Jens Gillessen.
Winter 2015	On *Frege's Foundations of Arithmetic* with Prof. Ingolf Max.
Winter 2015	On *Freedom of the Will and Moral Responsibility* with Prof. Kristina Musholt.
Winter 2015	On the *Philosophy of Hegel* with Prof. Pirmin Stekeler-Weithofer.

Other Skills and Work Experience

Languages	German	*Native*
	English	*Fluent*
	French	*Basic*
	Mandarin Chinese	*Basic*
	Ancient Greek	*Graecum*

Text-Production	*Editing* (completed 2 editing internships) *Literary Writing* (published numerous short stories and poems) *Journalism* (worked as a columnist)
Performance	*Moderating* (moderated a monthly reading stage for almost 15 years)